



Todd DeMelle <tdemelle@gmail.com>

genealogical research query

13 messages

Todd DeMelle <tdemelle@gmail.com>
To: ruthpbloom@gmail.com

Tue, Jul 23, 2019 at 11:35 PM

Dear Ruth,

I came across your name in the list of researchers on the National Archive webpage. I'm hoping you may be able to help me find more information about my great⁴ grandfather at whom my knowledge of my paternal family lineage ends.

His name is Levi Dimmell, but I have found it recorded differently in documents. Demel, Dimell, Demill. I believe he was born in 1784 in Europe, possibly Germany and he died in Nova Scotia in 1837. The most promising clue I have that may help provide more details on his origins is I believe he served in the King's German Legion in 1814.

I'm not sure the attribution, but my uncle has a note that Levi served 28 May 1814 • 60th Foot Reg. 7th Batt. King's German Legion

Doing some online searching, I found a record of this document in the National Archive that I hoped he might be listed in. <https://discovery.nationalarchives.gov.uk/details/r/C2471761>

From another of my uncle's notes, I believe he received a Land Grant in the Sherbrooke settlement, I believe a military settlement, in Lunenburg County in Nova Scotia in 1822.

Would you be able to investigate the referenced document and help me find out more about my ancestor?

Thank you for your help.

Sincerely,
Todd DeMelle

Ruth Bloom <ruthpbloom@gmail.com>
To: Todd DeMelle <tdemelle@gmail.com>

Wed, Jul 24, 2019 at 9:01 AM

Dear Todd

Thank you for your enquiry.

I can certainly have a look at the muster record for you. It won't give you much information about Levi, but will confirm that he was/wasn't there. I could also look at the years either side to see if I could find when he enlisted / left the regiment. (My hunch would be that he served until 1822, but that's just a guess).

I can't find anything specific about the Sherbrooke settlement, but there is document for Nova Scotia in the series [CO 381 - Entry Books, Series II: Commissions, Instructions, Petitions, Grants, Orders in Council, Warrants, Letters, etc.](#)

which covers 1816-1939. It's a long shot that this box will contain anything relevant but might be worth a look.

My fees are £25 per hour, and for payment from abroad I use Paypal which attracts a 5% overhead to cover their fees to me. My minimum fee is one hour, which would cover looking at the 1814 muster. If you wanted me to look at further musters (assuming I found him in 1814) and the Nova Scotia file you'd need to allow another hour or so.

Let me know what you think and how much time you are prepared for me to invest.

Best regards

Ruth Bloom
[Quoted text hidden]

Ruth Bloom <ruthpbloom@gmail.com>
To: Todd DeMelle <tdemelle@gmail.com>

Wed, Jul 24, 2019 at 10:44 AM

Dear Todd

I've just realised that he wouldn't have been in the KGL until 1822, as it appears to have been disbanded in 1816. I suppose he might have transferred to another regiment though.

Ruth
[Quoted text hidden]

Todd DeMelle <tdemelle@gmail.com>
To: Ruth Bloom <ruthpbloom@gmail.com>

Sat, Aug 3, 2019 at 12:12 PM

Hi Ruth,
Thank you for getting back to me and apologies for my delayed reply.

I would appreciate it if you would take a look at the muster record and the land grant document to see if there may be a clue that could help to follow my family thread further back. Two hours would be fine.

The final two notes my uncle has for Levi which may be clues to his time in the KGL are:

Departure: drafted into 2nd and 3rd battalions

25 August 1814 : Departure for Castine

My ultimate goal is to trace Levi back to our family's more remote European origins. If you have recommendations for other courses of investigation, I'd appreciate hearing your thoughts.

Thanks again, Ruth.

Sincerely,
Todd

Sent from my iPhone
[Quoted text hidden]

Todd DeMelle <tdemelle@gmail.com>
To: Ruth Bloom <ruthpbloom@gmail.com>

Sat, Aug 3, 2019 at 12:36 PM

Sherbrooke seems to have been a fort in Maine near Castine in 1814. Perhaps the soldiers stationed there were offered grants in Lunenburg County?

[http://www.fortwiki.com/Fort_Sherbrooke_\(2\)](http://www.fortwiki.com/Fort_Sherbrooke_(2))

Sent from my iPhone
[Quoted text hidden]

Todd DeMelle <tdemelle@gmail.com>
To: Ruth Bloom <ruthpbloom@gmail.com>

Sat, Aug 3, 2019 at 4:04 PM

Digging through my shelves today I came across a hard copy of a document that my Uncle gave me many years ago that has more detail on the source of the information on Levi's military career. I'm not sure what the attribution is referencing however... PANS: Military Papers H.Q.O. (Microfilm Reel #9216)? Do you know what that refers to? At any rate, here is a full transcription of the details pertaining to military career and land grant:

PANS: Military Papers H.Q.O. (Microfilm Reel #9216)
a.) Regiments and Corps
c.) Dates of Arrival

60th Reg. 7th Batt. arrival: 28 May 1814
departure: Drafted into 2nd and 3rd Battalions

p.15
60th Foot Regiment 7th Battalion
arrival: 28 May 1814 from Europe
departure: 25 August for Castine

SETTLEMENT

Regarding the circumstances of land grant, I located the following document (VF v. 139, #26):

"Military Settlements in Nova Scotia After the War of 1812", J.S. Martell, "read before the Nova Scotia Historical Society, January 8, 1937" [in "Collections of the Nova Scotia Historical Society". p. 75-105]

A portion of the text reads:

(p. 93)"In the meantime, about fifty Germans of the 7th battalion of the 60th had expressed their desire to settle in Lunenburg county. these men had fought with Wellington in Europe and with Sherbrooke at Castine, and Dalhousie decided that he had no hesitation in suggesting that they receive a share of His Majesty's bounty."

(p. 102)"The Germans of the 60th, or those who remained, were not ready until the second grant was made up in 1821. The grant of six thousand nine hundred acres, which went into effect in January, 1822, happily names the corps to which each man formerly belonged. Of the forty-five grantees, twenty-four had been in the Nova Scotia Fencibles (two of them had appeared on the previous grant), four in the Royal Artillery, two in the Newfoundland Fencibles, and one in the 76th. There were also two civilians, one the son of Captain Ross. From the foregoing, it would appear that 109 soldiers were confirmed in the possession of the nineteen thousand nine hundred acres in Sherbrooke."

Research conducted in Nova Scotia Archives in 2000 by Allen Robertson commissioned by Todd DeMelle

RG 20 "A": Post-1800 [Land Grant Papers]: DeMill, Levi ---see: Ross, William (Lieut.) & Others 1822

---Ross, William (Lieut.) & Others 1822: Draft Grant: to military settlers at Sherbrooke Settlement, 6900 acres of land in Lunenburg and Kings Counties. [Includes several German names: ... eg. Kiens, Graff, Clotiz, Shipain, Hession]: Levi DeMill-- 200 acres.

[Quoted text hidden]

Ruth Bloom <ruthpbloom@gmail.com>
To: Todd DeMelle <tdemelle@gmail.com>

Sun, Aug 4, 2019 at 3:59 AM

Hi Todd

I'm very glad you got back to me - in fact I've already spent a couple of hours in anticipation of your commission, and was hoping I would hear from you in due course.

As requested, I consulted the paylists for the Kings German Legion (KGL) in WO12/11922, but Levi Demell was not listed. The regiment was stationed in Palermo at the time, so I thought it was unlikely - but I photographed all the men whose names began with 'D' just to be sure.

I then turned my attention to the 7th battalion of the 60th Foot, also mentioned in your original email, and here I stuck gold - he's listed, and was there from 16 Dec 1813 until the 7th btn disbanded in 1817.

To digress before we get onto the detail of Levi Demell, let's address your latest email.

I do not recognise the reference PANS: Military Papers H.Q.O. (Microfilm Reel #9216). These notes refer to the history of the 60th Foot, rather than specifically to Levi, and I'm not sure they're accurate. I have the 60th Foot stationed in Halifax in December 1813 - pre-dating when these notes say they arrived from Europe. A Wikipedia search confirms that part of the 60th Foot was involved in the Capture of Castine, but I believe this was a detachment, as the main body of the regiment remained in Halifax, including Levi.

I took photographs of Levi's entry in the muster books for 1814 and 1815; (WO12/7088) .

- The first entry for him is the most interesting - he is noted as being present from 16th December 1813 - and his entry is annotated 'vol from Pris of War;' together with the 2 men below him. In this list he's given as 'Demel, Lewen', but I'm pretty sure this must be him. I'm pretty sure the bracket includes him as well

as the 2 following men, but I don't know what the comment 'as no 5' against all 3 of them means. I could possibly investigate this further by taking another look at the paylists. In subsequent paylists he appears as 'Leven Demell', 'Luen Demi', 'Lewin Demel', 'Leven Demell', 'Lew. Demel',. The spelling finally settles down to 'Leven Demell'.

I followed him into the next set of paylists in WO12/7089, but abandoned photographing every entry, until I got to the quarter when the 7th Btn was disbanded (Mar - Jun 1817). Here Leven is annotated with a check mark with 2 lines through it; Notes on the payroll say that 'men checked out thus ..are charged sub[sequentl]y in 3d B[atallio]n 60th per Return voucher 6 of P[ay] L[ist] to Sep 17 of that Bn'.

The Paylists for the 3rd Batallion are filed after this, but I could not see Leven listed there. Again, I could take another look just to be sure.

I have done a crash course in the 1812 war via internet resources, and discovered that there was a British internment camp on Halifax, which is were Leven was presumably a Prisoner of War until he volunteered for the 60th Foot.

This clearly begs more questions than answers - how come he was a Prisoner of War? Was he fighting for the USA, or was he captured from a foreign ship?

I'll leave you to ponder this, and have put the photographs in a Dropbox folder. I'm attaching the photo of his first entry to this email. (He's right at the bottom of the page)

This has taken way over 2 hours, but I'll only charge you 2 for the time being. let me know if you want me to do anything else - eg to re-examine the paylists etc. By the way, I checked the Nova Scotia file I mentioned and photographed the index to show that it didn't cover the land grant. i think the info you have already is as good as it gets for that one.

Best regards

Ruth

[Quoted text hidden]

2 attachments



P1070514.JPG
2934K



P1070513.JPG
3001K

Todd DeMelle <tdemelle@gmail.com>
To: Ruth Bloom <ruthpbloom@gmail.com>
Cc: Walter DeMelle <wdemelle@gmail.com>

Sun, Aug 4, 2019 at 10:31 AM

Thank you, Ruth!

May I introduce you to my uncle, Walter DeMelle who has been the primary torchbearer for DeMelle family genealogical research for many years, and ask that you add his name to your dropbox folder containing the photographs you have taken.

I'm so glad you had already begun researching! You present fascinating new information and clues for us... the dates and duration of Leven's career with the KGL, a thread to follow from the 7th to the 3rd Battalion in 1817, in addition to the very interesting revelation that he was a POW before volunteering for the 60th foot in 1813. From the rest of the photographed page it looks like quite a number of men were recorded similarly. What could 'as no 5' (and 'as no 34' or 'as no 7' in other entries) possibly refer to? Are these perhaps explained elsewhere in the volume? Can you share what the column headers for the entries are?

Please let me know what the fee for your work to date comes to and I will settle up with PayPal. I would like to continue discussing what avenues of investigation make sense to follow from here and will happily pay you for another round of investigation in the hope that perhaps we can find our way to the circumstances of Leven's birth and forebears. What clues do you think there may be still hiding in the paylists? Are there other sources that may hold more information regarding the events that lead to so many prisoners of war volunteering?

Thank you again, Ruth. This is exciting!

Sincerely,
Todd

[Quoted text hidden]

Ruth Bloom <ruthpbloom@gmail.com>
To: Todd DeMelle <tdemelle@gmail.com>
Cc: wdemelle@gmail.com

Sun, Aug 4, 2019 at 12:35 PM

Hi Todd and Walter

I've sent Walter an invitation to the Dropbox folder, and I've sent a Paypal request to Todd for invoice attached. Oh - paid already! Thanks!

I'm not sure we're going to get any information about Leven's birth and forebears from the Paylists - but I'd like to take another look at them to see whether I can figure out what the 'as no 5' annotation means, and also whether there are any other clues about the influx of prisoners of war. Believe me, I've scoured the internet trying to find out about this, as yet to no avail! There are also various websites which purport to list POWs, including this one <https://catalog.hathitrust.org/Record/008989499> which only has a limited search facility. There are no 'hits' on Demel(l) as far as I can see in either v1 or v2; nothing for 'Leven', but 5 hits for levi in v1 and 10 hits for Levi in v2. I don't think this book is available anywhere to which I have easy access, but you might want to check the 'find in a library' tab in case there's one local to either of you.

I would need to go back to the document to photograph the column headings for you.

If you'd like to authorise a further 3-4 hours, I'll look at the paylists again, and hunt around everywhere I can think of to see whether there are any PoW records, or general records about the Halifax facility which might yield further clues. I'll also investigate whether there are any histories of the 60th which might mention the influx of PoWs.

Best regards

Ruth
[Quoted text hidden]

 **tna190801Todd DeMelle.odt**
17K

Ruth Bloom <ruthpbloom@gmail.com>
To: Todd DeMelle <tdemelle@gmail.com>
Cc: wdemelle@gmail.com

Sun, Aug 4, 2019 at 12:45 PM

Hi both

I've checked in The national Archives (TNA) catalogue, and they hold various registers for PoWs at Halifax; some of these have been digitised and are on www.findmypast.co.uk, but a search here for Demel and variants does not give us anything. However I don't think all the registers have been digitised, so it would be worth me looking at these volumes to see if I can find LD. I think this would obviate the necessity of trying to locate the book mentioned in my previous email.

There may well be other sources at TNA as well...

Ruth

[Quoted text hidden]

Todd DeMelle <tdemelle@gmail.com>
To: Ruth Bloom <ruthpbloom@gmail.com>
Cc: Walter DeMelle <wdemelle@gmail.com>

Sun, Aug 4, 2019 at 3:45 PM

Thanks Ruth,
Consider the next round of research authorized!

There is a copy of 'American prisoners of war held at Halifax during the War of 1812' near me in Boston at the New England Historic Genealogical Society. Let me know if you think it might contain something not in the TNA that would make it worth a look.

[Quoted text hidden]

Ruth Bloom <ruthpbloom@gmail.com>
To: Todd DeMelle <tdemelle@gmail.com>
Cc: Walter DeMelle <wdemelle@gmail.com>

Sun, Aug 4, 2019 at 3:48 PM

I would hold off on the book until I've accessed the registers at TNA.

Thanks for the authorisation. I'll look at the file at TNA on Tuesday, so fingers crossed!

Ruth

[Quoted text hidden]

Todd DeMelle <tdemelle@gmail.com>
To: Walter DeMelle <wdemelle@gmail.com>

Sun, Aug 4, 2019 at 5:55 PM

Hi Skip,

Here's the email from Ruth that accompanied her dropbox photos. This is the fruit of the first investigation looking for Levi in military records at TNA in London.

[Quoted text hidden]

2 attachments



P1070514.JPG
2934K



P1070513.JPG
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